US History · Unit 9 · Level 2 (modified)

The 1920s & Harlem Renaissance



TODAY'S PLAN

- 🚂 The Great Migration and Red Summer
- 🎨 The Harlem Renaissance and jazz
- 🚫 Prohibition and gangsters
- 💃 Flappers, cars, radio and conflict

Review · 5 minutes

Quick Review



1️⃣9️⃣ The 19th Amendment (1920) let women vote.

⚖️ Jim Crow laws segregated the South (Unit 5).

🤔 Quick think: why might Black families leave the South?

Words to Know

Words to Know



Great Migration

When about 6 million Black Americans moved from the South to Northern and Western cities (1910–1970).



Harlem Renaissance

A burst of Black art, writing and music centered in Harlem, New York, in the 1920s.



Langston Hughes

A Harlem Renaissance poet who wrote “I, Too” (“I, too, sing America”).



Jazz

A new kind of music with Black roots, full of rhythm and improvising.

Words to Know

More Words to Know



🚫 **Prohibition**: The 18th Amendment (1920) banned making and selling alcohol; repealed in 1933.

🤫 **Speakeasy**: A hidden, illegal bar during Prohibition.

🕴️ **Gangster**: Criminals like Al Capone who got rich selling illegal alcohol.

💃 **Flapper**: A 1920s young woman with short hair and short dresses who broke old rules.

Compare

The Great Migration



Push (South)

Jim Crow laws
racist violence
sharecropping debt
boll weevil ruined cotton

Pull (North/West)

factory jobs (WWI)
the Chicago Defender newspaper
family already there
more freedom

Learn

Jacob Lawrence's “The Migration Series”



Painter **Jacob Lawrence** made 60 panels about the Great Migration (1941).

View them at the Phillips Collection website.

Visual themes: trains, crowds, work, family.

Learn

Red Summer and Tulsa



In **1919**, white mobs attacked Black neighborhoods in many cities (“Red Summer”).

In **1921**, a mob destroyed **Greenwood** in Tulsa, a wealthy Black neighborhood called “Black Wall Street.”

As many as 300 people died. It was hidden from history books for decades.

🃏 Check 1 of 3



Which was a PUSH factor for the Great Migration?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Factory jobs in Chicago

2️⃣ Jim Crow laws

3️⃣ The Chicago Defender

✅ Answer · Card 1 of 3



Jim Crow laws

Unfair laws pushed families out.

Learn

The Harlem Renaissance

Harlem (New York) became a center of Black art, writing and music.

Langston Hughes: “I, Too” — “I, too, sing America.”

Zora Neale Hurston wrote novels and collected Black folk stories.



Learn

Jazz Age Artists



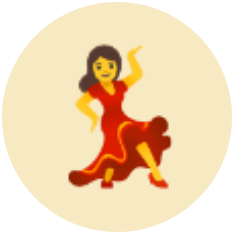
Louis Armstrong
trumpet, “Satchmo”



Duke Ellington
bandleader, Cotton Club



Bessie Smith
“Empress of the Blues”



Josephine Baker
dancer, star in Paris

🃏 Check 2 of 3



What is unique about jazz?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ It has no rhythm

2️⃣ It came from Europe only

3️⃣ Improvising and strong rhythm, with Black roots

✅ Answer · Card 2 of 3



Improvising and strong rhythm, with Black roots

Musicians make it up as they play.

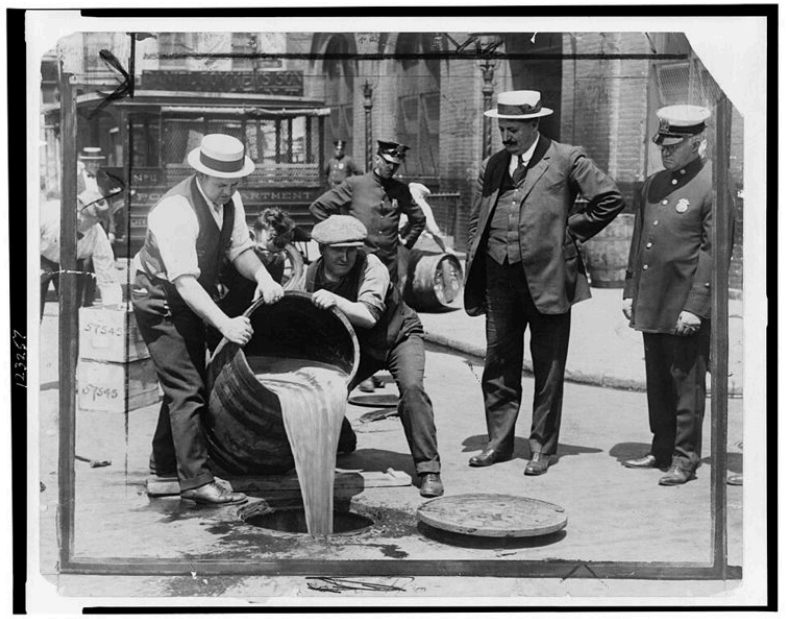
Learn

Prohibition (1920–1933)

The **18th Amendment** and **Volstead Act** banned making and selling alcohol.

Speakeasies and **bootleggers** sold it anyway. Stock car racing began with bootleggers' fast cars.

Gangster **Al Capone** ran Chicago crime; he was jailed for **tax evasion**. The **21st Amendment** ended Prohibition in 1933.



🃏 Check 3 of 3



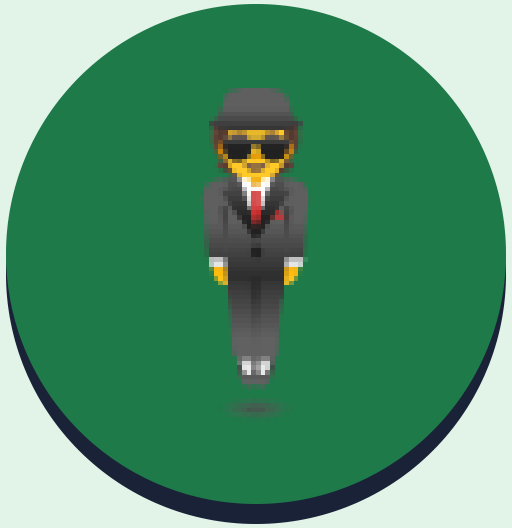
How was Al Capone finally sent to prison?

Hold up 1, 2, or 3:

1️⃣ Tax evasion

2️⃣ Speeding

3️⃣ Selling jazz records



Tax evasion

He didn't pay taxes on illegal income.

Learn

New Ways, Old Fights

Flappers cut their hair short and danced the Charleston.

Ford's Model T and the radio changed daily life.

Some resisted change: the **Scopes Trial** (1925) fought over teaching evolution.



Wrap-Up

Recap



Great Migration

South → North



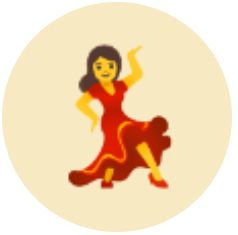
Harlem Renaissance

Hughes, Hurston, jazz



Prohibition

18th → 21st Amendment



Flapper

new freedoms

Wrap-Up

Exit Ticket



Give 1 push and 1 pull for the Great Migration.

Who were some jazz artists? What is unique about jazz?

What is a speakeasy? What is a flapper?